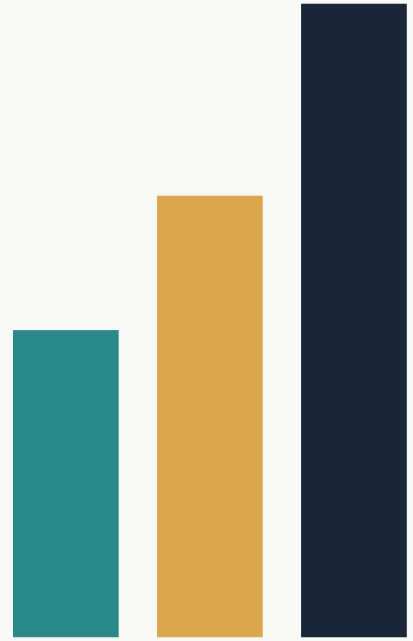
Y.AFISHA · BUSINESS ANALYSIS

Acquisition isn't the problem.

Retention is.

Unit economics of a ticketing platform: when the acquisition investment pays itself back, and what to do until it does.



LUCIANA JOST

Data Analytics Certification · TripleTen

Conversion is fast: it is not the bottleneck

36,523

customers converted at least once

The median time between first visit and first purchase is 16 minutes. A quarter of customers convert within 4 minutes. There is, however, a long tail: the third quartile reaches 2 days, and the maximum observed is over 363 days.

FOR THE INVESTOR

Fast conversion is not the problem.

The business challenge is not getting customers to buy for the first time, but what happens after that. That is where the analysis needs to focus.

Most customers buy once and never come back

1

order is the median per customer

1.38

orders per customer on average

At least half of the base placed only one order during the whole period. The 1.38 average sits above the median only because a small group of customers places up to 239 orders each, pulling the number up.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Repeat purchase, not acquisition, is the growth lever.

More new customers alone won't fix this. The bigger gain is getting people who already bought to buy again.

A small share of customers drives the revenue

€3.05

median revenue per customer

€11,810

revenue from the highest-value customer

Revenue per customer is strongly skewed: the mean (€6.90) is more than twice the median (€3.05), a clear sign that a few high-value customers pull the total up, while most spend little.

FOR THE INVESTOR

Not every customer is worth the same.

Knowing what defines top-revenue customers lets you focus retention and personalization on the people who matter most.

Retention collapses in the very first month

4.2% – 8.5%

first-month retention rate, varying by cohort

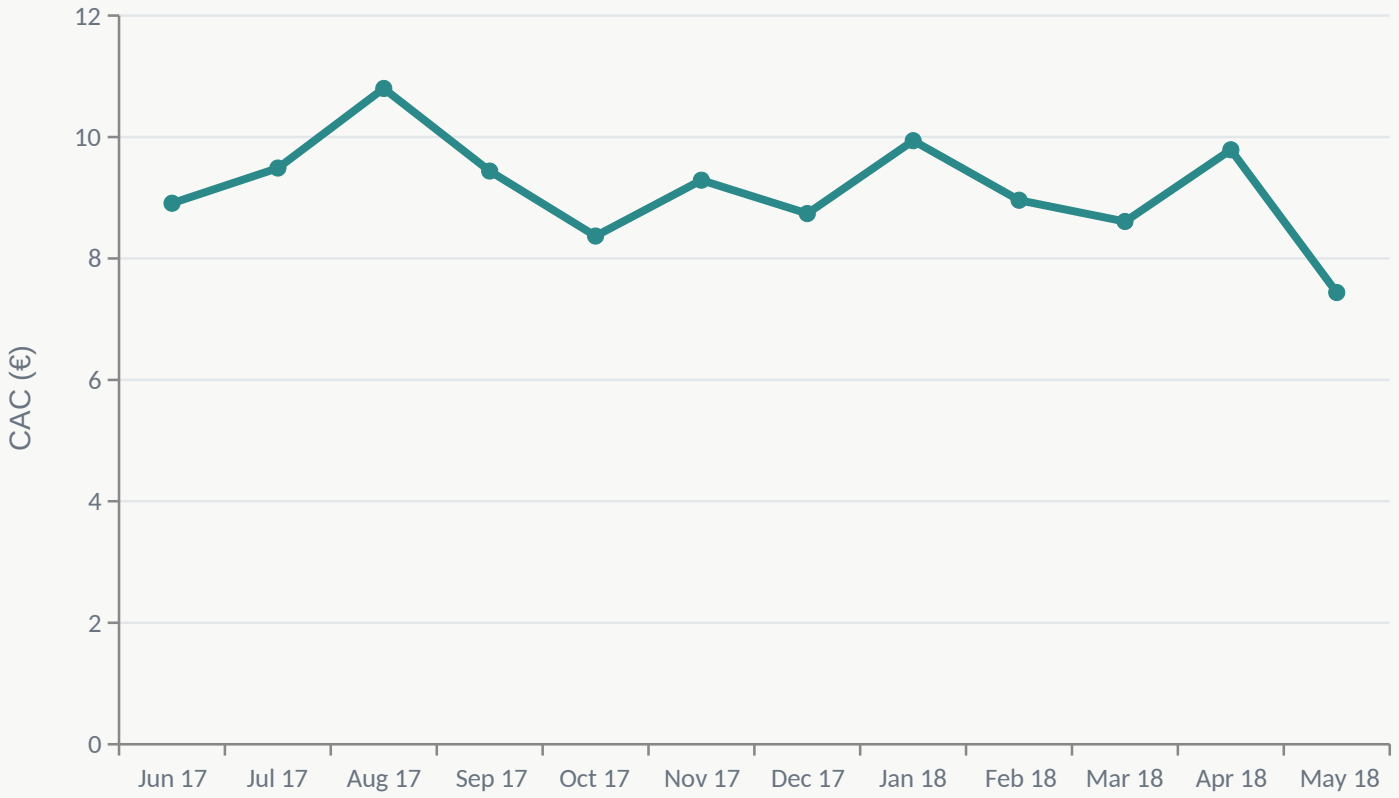
Out of every 100 customers acquired, only 4 to 9 are still active a month later. The pattern repeats in every cohort analysed, from June 2017 to May 2018, with no relevant exception.

FOR THE INVESTOR

This is where most of the value is lost.

A drop this size in the first month shows the problem is not acquisition itself, but everything that happens between the first and second visit: onboarding, communication and a reason to come back.

CAC fluctuated, but with no upward trend



THE SIGNAL

€7.44 – €10.80

monthly CAC range over 12 months

The highest cost was in August 2017 (€10.80). The lowest, in May 2018 (€7.44). With no steady increase, the payback problem is not acquisition getting more expensive.

ROMI grows, but does not recover CAC within the observed window



THE SIGNAL

0.67

avg. cumulative ROMI, month 11 (target 1.00)

No cohort recovered its CAC within the observed window. The best was September 2017, with a ROMI of about 0.71 in the eighth month.

Four priorities to improve unit economics

01

RETENTION AND REPEAT PURCHASE

A customer lifecycle with onboarding, post-purchase communication and reactivation campaigns.

02

VALUE-BASED ACQUISITION

Shift investment to the sources with the best LTV to CAC ratio, not just volume.

03

CUSTOMER VALUE

Replicate the patterns of high-revenue customers through cross-sell, up-sell and personalization.

04

CONVERSION FRICTION

Test journey improvements between acquisition and first purchase for the slower tail.

CASE · Increase retention and customer value before scaling acquisition.

THE RECOMMENDATION

Grow value before volume.

Retention before acquisition.

Prioritize retention and repeat-purchase strategies, direct acquisition investment to the sources with the best ratio between value generated and cost, and treat the first purchase as the start of the relationship, not the end of the funnel.

The data supports this prioritization. Execution will determine how fast the business recovers its acquisition investment.

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